THE DIOCESE OF
CHURCHES
FOR THE SAKE
OF OTHERS

Letters Dimissory April 20, 2026
Rev. Joshua Steele

To Whom It May Concern,

Grace and peace to you in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ.

This letter is to certify that Joshua Steele, having signified his desire to resign Holy Orders within the Anglican Church of North America (ACNA), is a priest canonically resident in the Diocese of Churches for the Sake of Others (C4SO). At the time of this resignation, Joshua is in good standing and has not, as far as I know or believe, been justly liable to evil report for error in religion or viciousness of life during the past three years.

It may be helpful to clarify the ecclesial understanding under which this resignation is received. Within the ACNA, Holy Orders are understood to be conferred and exercised within a particular ecclesial body and its ordered life. We do not recognize Holy Orders as a trans-denominational or free-floating reality that transcends concrete traditions or jurisdictions. Accordingly, should one seek to minister sacramentally within another Christian communion, ordination would be required according to the discipline and polity of that tradition.

From the perspective of C4SO and the ACNA, therefore, Rev. Steele is understood to have resigned Holy Orders as held and exercised within this ecclesial body. This resignation is received without discipline and in good standing.

I am glad to affirm to any future inquirers that Rev. Steele resigned Holy Orders in good standing and was not under ecclesiastical discipline at the time of resignation. Beyond that affirmation, Joshua remains free to articulate his own personal theological understanding of Holy Orders in other contexts. This letter simply reflects the understanding and record of the Church under whose authority he was ordained and served.

Grace and Peace,

Jeffrey W. Bailey

The Rt. Rev. Dr. Jeff Bailey
Bishop Ordinary
Diocese of Churches for the Sake of Others (ACNA)